

Communication

GOALS MONTH 4

- You can apply the I-Message model in a real situation from your sports life
- You give constructive feedback to a teammate without triggering blame
- You plan and have at least one difficult conversation you have been postponing

How you speak determines how you work together. You learn the difference between reacting and truly communicating, and how to give feedback without damaging relationships.

EXERCISE 1 — THE I-MESSAGE**1 The I-Message**

Model: "I see... I feel... I need... I ask you to..." Think of a real situation.

The situation:

I SEE...

I FEEL...

I NEED...

I ASK YOU TO...

EXERCISE 2 — THE CONVERSATION I KEEP POSTPONING**2 The Conversation I Keep Postponing**

Write a conversation you've wanted to have but keep postponing — with a coach, teammate, or parent.

With whom?

Why do I keep postponing it?

The first sentence I will use to open the conversation:

EXERCISE 3 — AFTER THE FEEDBACK ROUND

3 Feedback Round Reflection

What was the best feedback you received? What will you concretely do with it?

The best feedback I received:

What will I concretely do with it?

What did I learn about how I give feedback myself?

MENTAL RESILIENCE — LISTENING UNDER PRESSURE

During the next critical moment in training: breathe in 2× deeply before responding. Write afterward: what was the moment and how did I respond differently?

"The single biggest problem in communication is the illusion that it has taken place."

— George Bernard Shaw — Nobelprijswinnaar Literatuur